5 Best Practices for Building AI Agent Skills

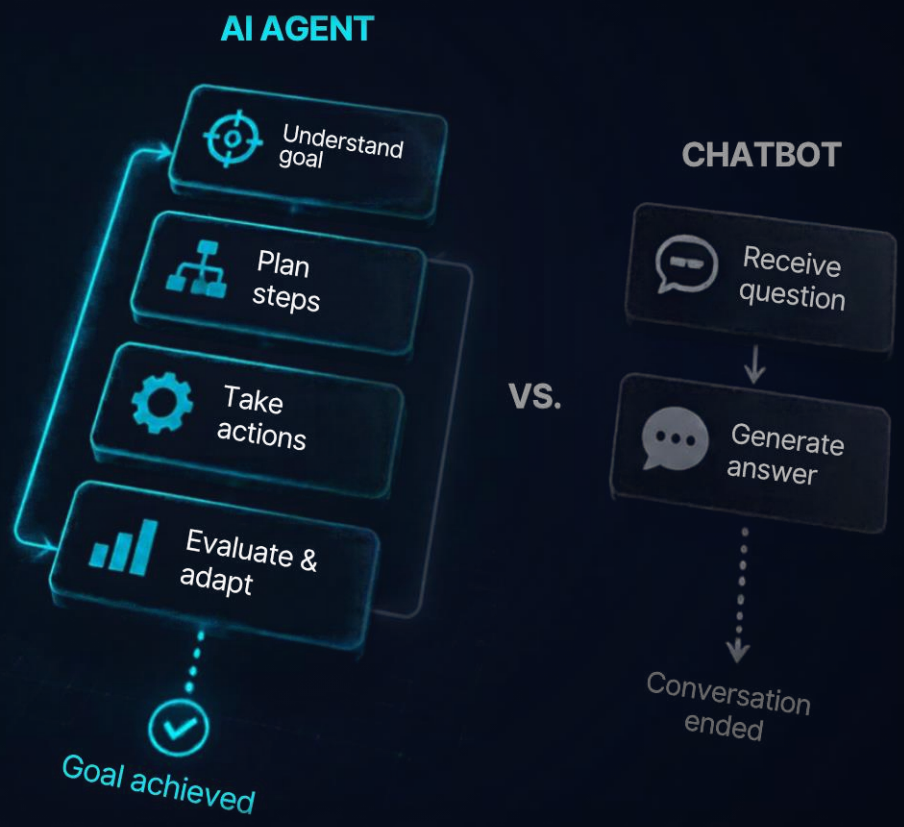


Carina Domat

What is an

AI Agent?

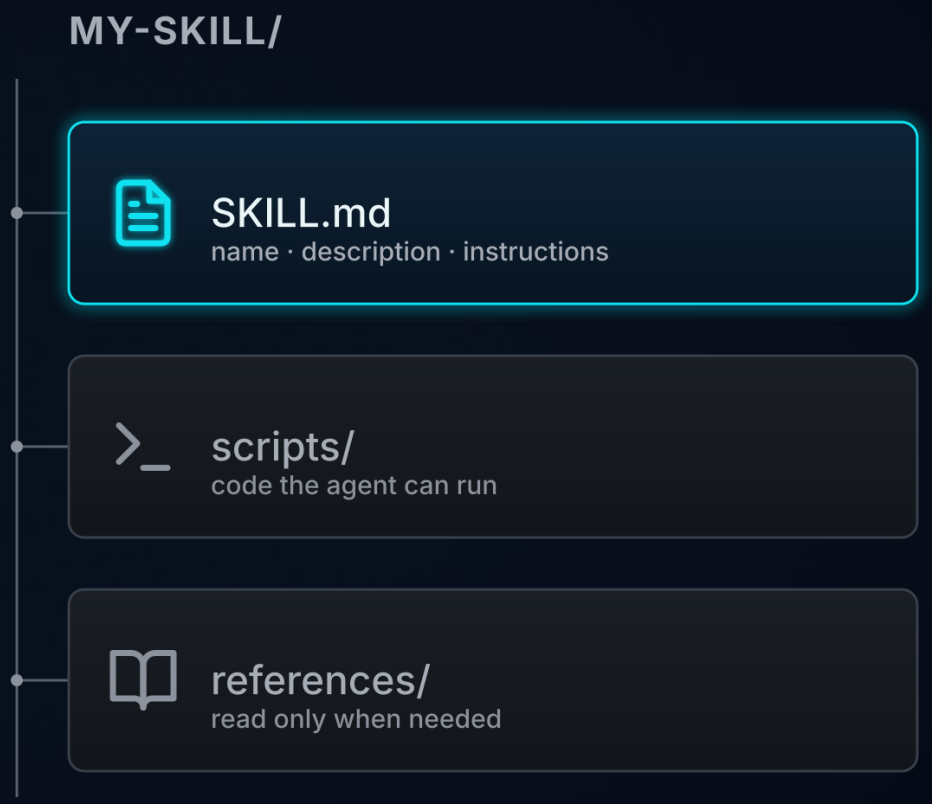
Plans and acts, not just answers



What is an

Agent Skill?

Procedural knowledge, not just facts



01

The description is the trigger

Say when, not just what.

WHAT THE AGENT SEES AT STARTUP

TOO VAGUE

"A compliance skill that generates reports"

vs.

GETS TRIGGERED

"Generates the monthly compliance report. Use when asked for the monthly filing."

name ≤ 64 characters · description ≤ 1,024

02

Build from real expertise

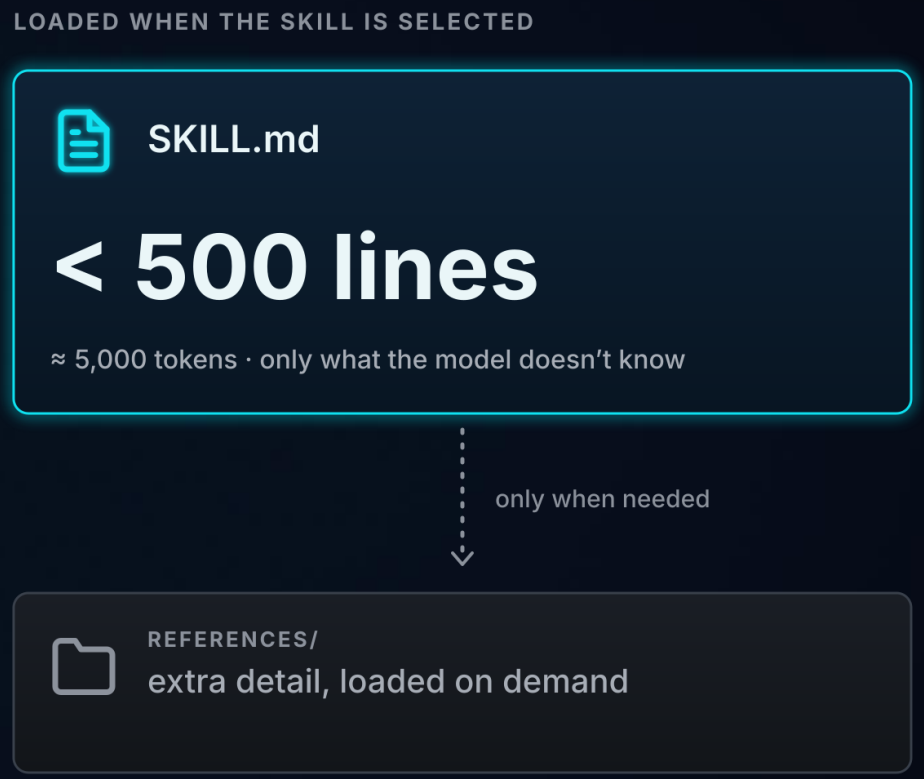
Every gotcha, written down.



03

Spend context wisely

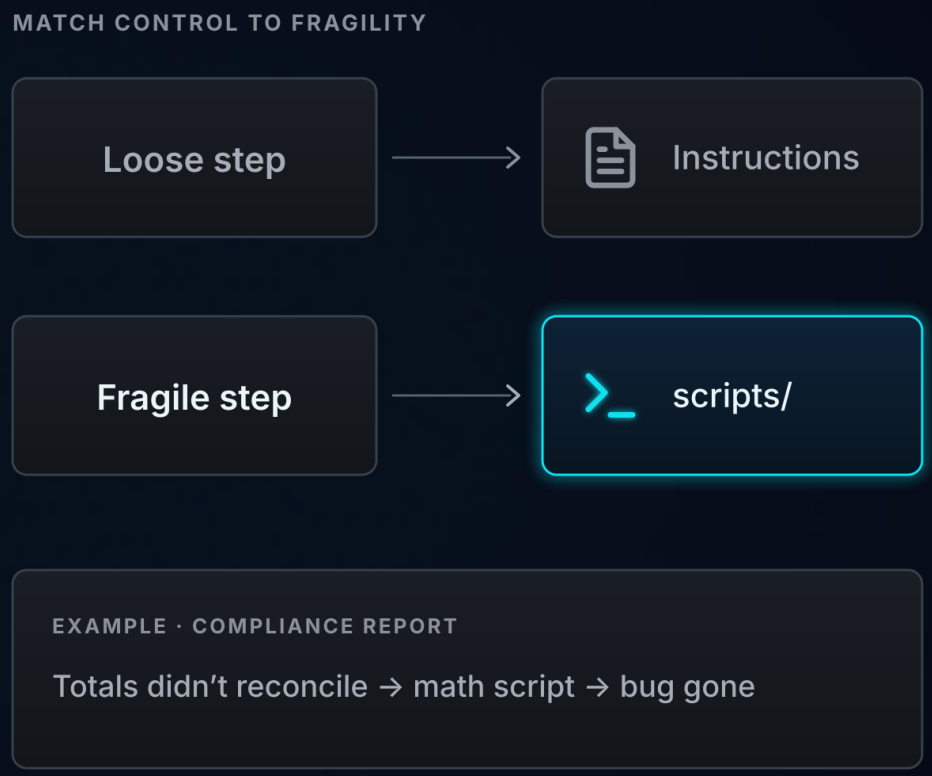
Lean body, details on demand.



04

Use deterministic scripts

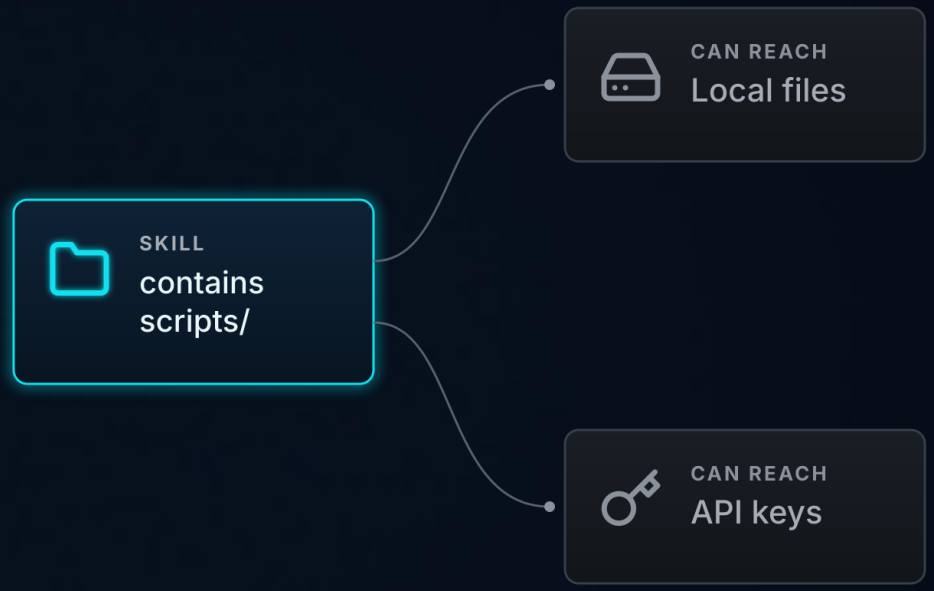
Fragile step?
Write code.



05

Vet a skill before you run it

A skill can run code.



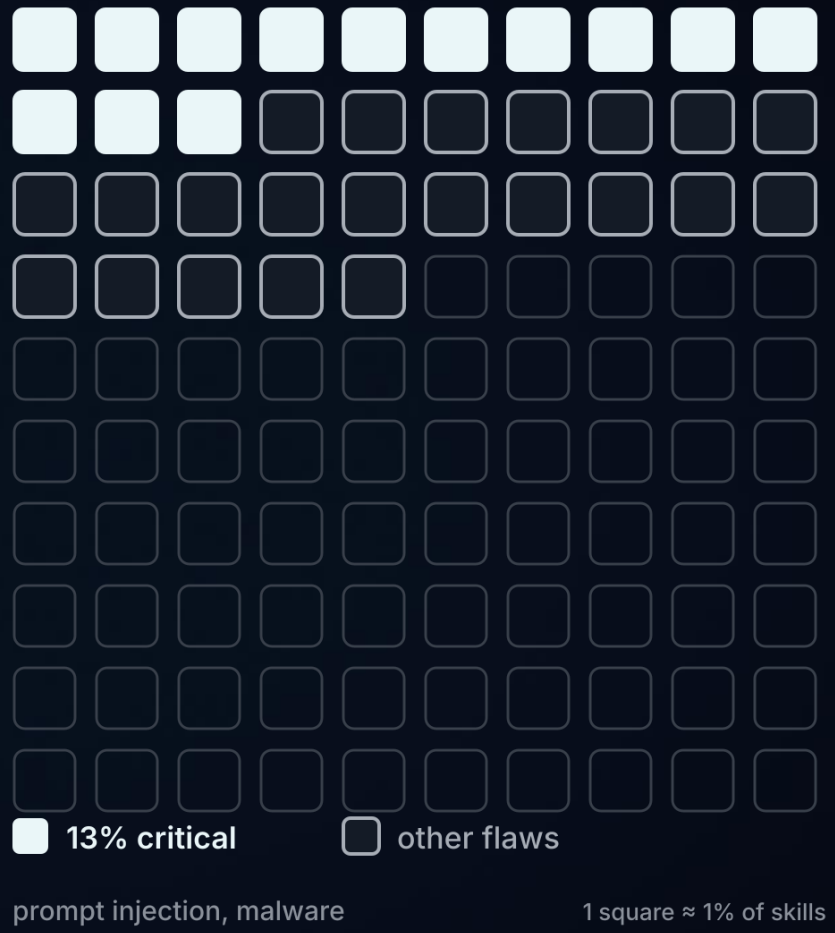
Open standard ≠ safe skill

05

35%+

of ~4,000 public skills had a security flaw

Treat it like any dependency.



Summary

01 **Trigger** the description says what and when

02 **Expertise** write down every gotcha

03 **Context** lean body, details in references/

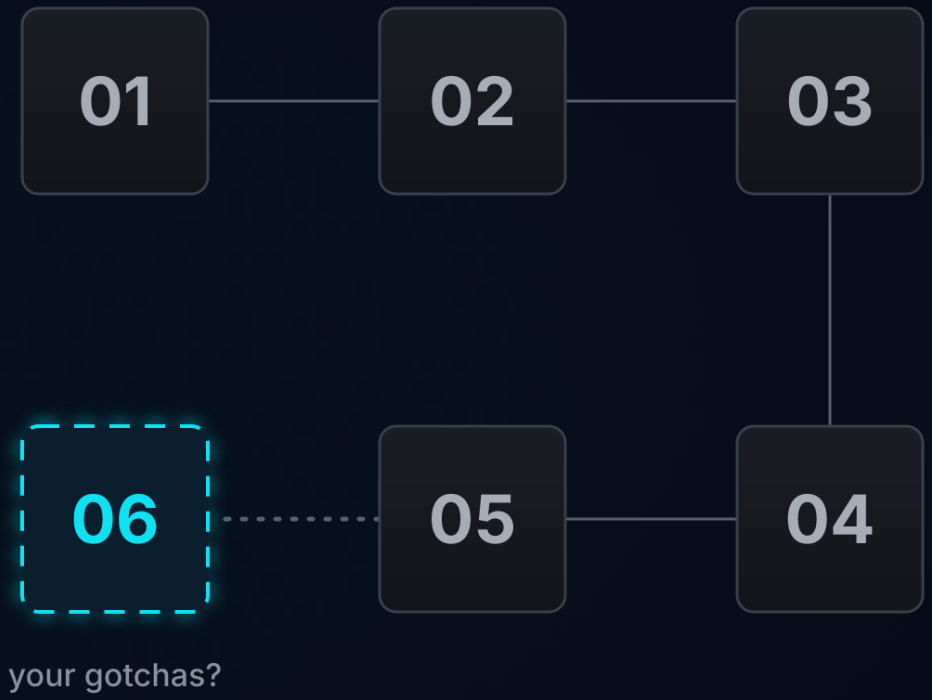
04 **Scripts** code for every fragile step

05 **Vetting** read a skill before it runs

Outlook

Agent skills are an open standard

This list isn't final.



References

5 Best Practices for Building AI Agent Skills:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qYNs80FKIVc

AgentSkills.io:
https://agentskills.io/home